Saket Saurav

Principal Cloud Engineer | Cloud & AI Architecture | Multi-Cloud & OKE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Distinguished Principal Cloud Engineer with 12+ years of enterprise IT engineering excellence, including 6.5+ years of deep specialization in Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI) and Multi-Cloud architectures (Azure, AWS, GCP). Proven architectural track record designing, migrating, and operating mission-critical, telecom-grade cloud estates and regulated air-gapped environments for global enterprises. Specialized in enterprise Kubernetes (OKE) platform engineering (private clusters, FSS persistent storage, RBAC governance, and ingress architecture), Zero Trust enterprise security, OCI IAM database environment isolation, and SAML 2.0 / Azure AD federated SSO.

Recognized for bridging strategic enterprise architecture, cloud-native scalability, zero-trust security, and AI-powered operational autonomy. Hands-on leader with extensive delivery across private OKE cluster topologies, modular Terraform IaC automation, GenAI CloudOps dashboards, and enterprise database modernization (Exadata, Autonomous Database). Accomplished in directing cross-functional engineering teams, authoring technical decision records (TDRs), and establishing organizational landing zone governance.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Container & Cloud-Native Platforms:** Kubernetes (OKE), Docker, Helm, Private OKE Clusters, FSS Persistent Storage (StorageClass, PV, PVC), Layered Security & RBAC, Application Load Balancers (ALB/NLB), API Gateway Ingress
- **Enterprise Cloud Architecture:** Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI - Primary), Multi-Cloud (Azure, AWS, GCP), Landing Zones, VCN Hub-and-Spoke, DRG, FastConnect, Private DNS, Network Firewalls (Palo Alto VM-Series), High Availability & DR Topology
- **AI & GenAI Platform Engineering:** LangChain, LangGraph, Local LLMs, Model Context Protocol (MCP) Servers, Agentic AI Frameworks, RAG Architecture, GenAI CloudOps Dashboard, Offline ChatOps CLI, ODAOS (Autonomous DB Ops)
- **Zero Trust Security & Identity:** OCI IAM Identity Domains, Azure Active Directory / Microsoft Entra ID Federation, SAML 2.0 / SSO, SCIM Provisioning, Okta Integration, Linux PAM Hardening, OCI IAM Database Environment Isolation, Confidential Applications
- **Observability, SRE & Governance:** Prometheus, Grafana, Splunk, Datadog, OCI Logging Analytics, Service Connector Hub, ONS Alerting, Multi-Cloud Cost Governance (Cloudability), Capacity Planning & Performance Tuning
- **Infrastructure as Code & DevOps:** Terraform (Reusable Modular Blueprints), Ansible, OCI Resource Manager, OCI CLI, Bash Scripting, OCI DevOps, Git, GitHub Actions, Automated CI/CD Pipelines, Multi-Environment Release Governance
- **Databases & Mission-Critical Data:** Oracle Database 19c/12c/11g, Oracle RAC (Real Application Clusters), Exadata Database Service (ExaCS), Autonomous Data Warehouse (ADW), Autonomous DB (ADB), Data Guard, RMAN Backup & Recovery

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal Cloud Engineer (OCI) / Manager-Projects • Cognizant (Client: KPN (Netherlands)) *2024-11 – 2026-07 (1.7 yrs)*

- **Cloud Architecture & Landing Zones:** Owned the architecture of a production-grade, air-gapped Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI) environment for telecom billing platforms (DBSS Revenue Management / BRM modernization), defining landing zone, network domains, connectivity model, and isolation boundaries.
- **Cloud Architecture & Governance:** Produced architecture design documents, technical decision records (TDRs), and operational runbooks covering network topology, platform dependencies, environment patterns, and support procedures, improving implementation clarity and governance traceability.
- **Network & Trust Architecture:** Defined segmentation and trust architecture across OKE, database, storage, bastion, and shared services tiers, establishing private DNS and service discovery across hub-and-spoke VCNs using delegated zones and environment-specific namespace separation.
- **Kubernetes (OKE) Engineering:** Provisioned and managed production private OKE clusters enforcing layered security, blast-radius containment, and network policies, resolving complex OKE operational issues and reducing platform incidents by ~40%.
- **Stateful Storage & Ingress:** Engineered OCI FSS-backed persistent storage (StorageClass, PV, PVC) for stateful telecom billing workloads; configured ALB/NLBs and API Gateways with DNS-based routing and enterprise TLS for secure, scalable external ingress.
- **Cluster Security & RBAC:** Implemented Kubernetes-native RBAC and authentication model in the absence of external identity providers, achieving secure multi-tenant access control entirely within cluster boundaries.
- **Infrastructure as Code:** Automated end-to-end OCI infrastructure provisioning using modular Terraform (networking, compute, OKE clusters, FSS storage), reducing deployment time by ~60% and eliminating configuration drift across environments.
- **Governance & CI/CD:** Developed robust OCI CLI / Bash automation for bulk resource tagging and compliance governance across hundreds of OCI resources; engineered CI/CD pipelines integrating OCI DevOps for automated deployments.
- **AI-Driven Operations (GenAI CloudOps):** Architected and delivered a GenAI-powered CloudOps Dashboard integrating OCI Monitoring, cost analysis, security insights, and automated remediation workflows, pioneering AI-driven operations for KPN's cloud estate.
- **Air-Gapped ChatOps & Local LLMs:** Developed an offline ChatOps CLI using LangChain and local LLMs for secure AI-assisted diagnostics in air-gapped OCI environments, enabling intelligent incident triaging without internet dependency.
- **Autonomous DB Operations (ODAOS):** Spearheaded ODAOS (Oracle Database Autonomous Operations System) implementation, automating complex database operations and reducing manual DBA intervention by ~50%.
- **Model Context Protocol (MCP) & AI Tooling:** Modernized API integrations by migrating legacy frameworks to next-generation AI models via Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers, leveraging Cursor IDE for accelerated cloud development.
- **Security, IAM & Zero Trust:** Designed and executed a successful POC for OCI IAM Database Environment Isolation, hardening non-production environments and establishing a blueprint adopted for production rollout.
- **Enterprise Federation & SAML:** Implemented federated identity integration between OCI and KPN enterprise IAM (Azure Active Directory) using SAML-based SSO; automated OS-level PAM configuration to enforce strict access controls; designed confidential application patterns in OCI IAM.
- **Leadership & Stakeholder Mentorship:** Mentored and supervised junior cloud engineers, setting structured growth goals; collaborated directly with cross-functional stakeholders (identity, network, security, PMO) to align cloud architecture with business requirements.

OCI Cloud Administrator • Emerson (EITS) *2018-06 – 2024-11 (6.5 yrs)*

- **Enterprise Cloud Migration:** Defined and executed cloud migration strategy from on-premises to OCI (ExaCS and IaaS), architecting VCNs, DRGs, Palo Alto VM-Series Firewalls, and IPSec VPN for secure hybrid connectivity supporting Emerson's global business.
- **Hub-and-Spoke Networking:** Architected hub-and-spoke OCI network topology with NLBs, Application LBs, Network Firewalls, and cross-region/cross-tenancy connectivity solutions supporting enterprise workload migration.
- **Enterprise IAM Governance:** Implemented enterprise IAM governance integrating Okta and Azure AD with OCI Identity Domain for SSO and SCIM provisioning, enforcing strict least-privilege control policies.
- **Core Infrastructure Provisioning:** Led provisioning, configuration, and capacity scaling of OCI services: Compute, ExaDB, ADW, OAC, Linux VMs, Object Storage, and Block Volumes based on business demands.
- **Centralized Logging & Observability:** Implemented centralized logging architecture using OCI Logging Service and Splunk; integrated Datadog, Cloudability, and Infoblox for multi-cloud observability and cost governance across OCI and GCP.
- **IaC Automation:** Utilized Terraform and OCI Resource Manager for Infrastructure-as-Code deployments, driving infrastructure repeatability and eliminating manual provisioning overhead.
- **Disaster Recovery & SRE:** Developed and maintained DR runbooks, network architecture diagrams, and OCI configuration documentation, ensuring operational readiness, high availability, and knowledge continuity.
- **Performance & Capacity Tuning:** Monitored OCI environments using Prometheus and Grafana, performing proactive capacity planning and performance tuning to optimize resource utilization and cloud cost efficiency.
- **Database Administration:** Administered Oracle DB 19c/12c, RAC, and Exadata (on-premise and cloud), managing high-availability backup/recovery (RMAN), Data Guard, patching, cloning, and production upgrades.

Oracle DBA / BI Administrator • ITC Infotech *2016-11 – 2018-06 (1.7 yrs)*

- **Database Administration:** Administered Oracle Database 12c/11g production environments, managing proactive performance tuning, RMAN backup & recovery, patching, and cloning for enterprise mission-critical systems.
- **BI & Data Integration:** Supported Oracle Business Intelligence (OBIEE) and Oracle Data Integrator (ODI) platforms, including deployment, configuration, pipeline orchestration, and troubleshooting.
- **Middleware Administration:** Managed Oracle WebLogic Server administration for middleware hosting of BI and enterprise analytics applications.

Oracle DBA / BI Administrator • Tech Mahindra *2014-01 – 2016-10 (2.7 yrs)*

- **Production DBA & RAC:** Delivered comprehensive Oracle DBA services for production and DR environments, including Oracle RAC administration, Data Guard configuration, performance tuning, and space management.
- **Analytics & Data Pipelines:** Supported Oracle Analytics Server (OAS/OBIEE) deployments and managed large-scale data migration workflows using DB links, Export/Import, and ODI pipelines.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Architect Professional** – Oracle (2026)
- **Oracle Cloud Infrastructure DevOps Professional** – Oracle (2026)
- **Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Generative AI Professional** – Oracle (2026)
- **Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Certified Architect Associate** – Oracle (2026)
- **Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Certified Generative AI Architect** – Oracle (2026)
- **Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Certified Autonomous Database Architect** – Oracle (2026)

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech) in Electronics & Communication Engineering • Suresh Gyan Vihar University, Jaipur (70%)